

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 14

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

163. Chapter 14 Verses 1-5

VERSE 14.1

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
परं भूयः प्रवक्ष्यामि ज्ञानानां ज्ञानमुत्तमम् ।
यज्ज्ञात्वा मुनयः सर्वे परां सिद्धिमितो गताः ॥ १ ॥

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha
param bhūyaḥ pravakṣhyāmi jñānānām jñānam uttamam
yaj jñātvā munayaḥ sarve parām siddhim ito gatāḥ

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Divine Lord said; **param**—supreme; **bhūyaḥ**—again; **pravakṣhyāmi**—I shall explain; **jñānānām**—of all knowledge; **jñānam uttamam**—the supreme wisdom; **yaj**—which; **jñātvā**—knowing; **munayaḥ**—saints; **sarve**—all; **parām**—highest; **siddhim**—perfection; **itaḥ**—through this; **gatāḥ**—attained

The Lord said: Once more I will expound that Supreme Knowledge, the most exalted of all forms of knowledge, by gaining which all the sages have attained highest perfection.

VERSE 14.2

इदं ज्ञानमुपाश्रित्य मम साधर्म्यमागताः ।
सर्गेऽपि नोपजायन्ते प्रलये न व्यथन्ति च ॥ 2 ॥

idaṁ jñānam upāśhritya mama sādharṁyam āgatāḥ
sarge 'pi nopajāyante pralaye na vyathanti cha

idaṁ—this; **jñānam**—wisdom; **upāśhritya**—take refuge in; **mama**—mine; **sādharṁyam**—of similar nature; **āgatāḥ**—having attained; **sarge**—at the time of creation; **api**—even; **na**—not; **upajāyante**—are born; **pralaye**—at the time of dissolution; **na-vyathanti**—they will not experience misery; **cha**—and

They who, having devoted themselves to this Knowledge, have partaken of My nature, are not born at the time of creation, nor are they troubled at the time of dissolution.

VERSE 14.3

मम योनिर्महद् ब्रह्म तस्मिन्गर्भं दधाम्यहम् ।
सम्भवः सर्वभूतानां ततो भवति भारत ॥ ३ ॥

mama yonir mahad brahma tasmin garbham dadhāmy aham
sambhavaḥ sarva-bhūtānām tato bhavati bhārata

mama—my; **yonih**—womb; **mahat brahma**—the total material substance, prakṛiti; **tasmin**—in that; **garbham**—womb; **dadhāmi**—impregnate; **aham**—I; **sambhavaḥ**—birth; **sarva-bhūtānām**—of all living beings; **tataḥ**—thereby; **bhavati**—becomes; **bhārata**—Arjun, the son of Bharat;

**The Great Nature is My womb; in that I place the seed of life,
and thence are born all beings, O Bhārata.**

VERSE 14.4

सर्वयोनिषु कौन्तेय मूर्तयः सम्भवन्ति याः ।
तासां ब्रह्म महद्योनिरहं बीजप्रदः पिता ॥ ४ ॥

sarva-yoniṣhu kaunteya mūrtayaḥ sambhavanti yāḥ
tāsāṁ brahma mahad yonir ahaṁ bīja-pradaḥ pitā

sarva—all; **yoniṣhu**—species of life; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **mūrtayaḥ**—forms; **sambhavanti**—are produced; **yāḥ**—which; **tāsām**—of all of them; **brahma-mahat**—great material nature; **yoniḥ**—womb; **aham**—I; **bīja-pradaḥ**—seed-giving; **pitā**—Father

Whatever form is produced, O son of Kunti, in any womb, the Great Nature is its womb, and I am the seed-giving Father.

VERSE 14.5

सत्त्वं रजस्तम इति गुणाः प्रकृतिसम्भवाः ।
निबध्नन्ति महाबाहो देहे देहिनमव्ययम् ॥ ५ ॥

sattvaṁ rajas tama iti guṇāḥ prakṛiti-sambhavāḥ
nibadhnanti mahā-bāho dehe dehinam avyayam

sattvam—mode of goodness; **rajaḥ**—mode of passion; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **iti**—thus; **guṇāḥ**—modes; **prakṛiti**—material nature; **sambhavāḥ**—consists of; **nibadhnanti**—bind; **mahā-bāho**—mighty-armed one; **dehe**—in the body; **dehinam**—the embodied soul; **avyayam**—eternal

O Arjuna! Born of Prakriti, the three Gunas, Sattva, Rajas, and Tamas bind the imperishable Jivatma in the body.

164. Chapter 14 Verse 6

VERSE 14.6

तत्र सत्त्वं निर्मलत्वात्प्रकाशकमनामयम् ।
सुखसङ्गेन बध्नाति ज्ञानसङ्गेन चानघ ॥ ६ ॥

tatra sattvaṁ nirmalatvāt prakāśhakam anāmayam
sukha-saṅgena badhnāti jñāna-saṅgena chānagha

tatra—amongst these; **sattvaṁ**—mode of goodness; **nirmalatvāt**—being purest;
prakāśhakam—illuminating; **anāmayam**—healthy and full of well-being;
sukha—happiness; **saṅgena**—attachment; **badhnāti**—binds; **jñāna**—knowledge;
saṅgena—attachment; **cha**—also; **anagha**—Arjun, the sinless one

Of these, sattva, being stainless, is luminous and healthful. It binds, O sinless Arjuna, by creating attachment to happiness and attachment to knowledge.

165. Chapter 14 Verses 6-10

VERSE 14.6

तत्र सत्त्वं निर्मलत्वात्प्रकाशकमनामयम् ।
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tatra—amongst these; **sattvam**—mode of goodness; **nirmalatvāt**—being purest;
prakāśhakam—illuminating; **anāmayam**—healthy and full of well-being;
sukha—happiness; **saṅgena**—attachment; **badhnāti**—binds; **jñāna**—knowledge;
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Of these, sattva, being stainless, is luminous and healthful. It binds, O sinless Arjuna, by creating attachment to happiness and attachment to knowledge.

VERSE 14.7

रजो रागात्मकं विद्धि तृष्णासङ्गसमुद्भवम् ।
तन्निबध्नाति कौन्तेय कर्मसङ्गेन देहिनम् ॥ ७ ॥

rajo rāgātmakam viddhi tṛiṣṇā-saṅga-samudbhavam
tan nibadhnāti kaunteya karma-saṅgena dehinam

rajaḥ—mode of passion; **rāga-ātmakam**—of the nature of passion; **viddhi**—know; **tṛiṣṇā**—desires; **saṅga**—association; **samudbhavam**—arises from; **tat**—that; **nibadhnāti**—binds; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **karma-saṅgena**—through attachment to fruitive actions; **dehinam**—the embodied soul

Know that rajas is the essence of passion and the cause of thirst and attachment. It binds fast the embodied soul, O son of Kunti, by attachment to action.

VERSE 14.8

तमस्त्वज्ञानजं विद्धि मोहनं सर्वदेहिनाम् ।
प्रमादालस्यनिद्राभिस्तन्निबध्नाति भारत ॥ ८ ॥

tamas tv ajñāna-jam viddhi mohanam sarva-dehinām
pramādālasya-nidrābhis tan nibadhnāti bhārata

tamaḥ—mode of ignorance; **tu**—but; **ajñāna-jam**—born of ignorance; **viddhi**—know; **mohanam**—illusion; **sarva-dehinām**—for all the embodied souls; **pramāda**—negligence; **ālasya**—laziness; **nidrābhiḥ**—sleep; **tat**—that; **nibadhnāti**—binds; **bhārata**—Arjun, the son of Bharat

And know further that **tamas** is born of ignorance and that it deludes all embodied creatures. It binds fast, O **Bhārata**, by inadvertence, indolence, and sleep.

VERSE 14.9

सत्त्वं सुखे सञ्जयति रजः कर्मणि भारत ।
ज्ञानमावृत्य तु तमः प्रमादे सञ्जयत्युत ॥ ९ ॥

sattvaṁ sukhe sañjayati rajaḥ karmaṇi bhārata
jñānam āvṛitya tu tamaḥ pramāde sañjayaty uta

sattvam—mode of goodness; **sukhe**—to happiness; **sañjayati**—binds; **rajaḥ**—mode of passion; **karmaṇi**—toward actions; **bhārata**—Arjun, the son of Bharat; **jñānam**—wisdom; **āvṛitya**—clouds; **tu**—but; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **pramāde**—to delusion; **sañjayati**—binds; **uta**—indeed

Sattva binds one to happiness, and rajas to action, O Bhārata; whereas tamas veils knowledge and binds one to inadvertence.

VERSE 14.10

रजस्तमश्चाभिभूय सत्त्वं भवति भारत ।

रजः सत्त्वं तमश्चैव तमः सत्त्वं रजस्तथा ॥ 10 ॥

rajas tamaśh chābhibhūya sattvaṁ bhavati bhārata

rajaḥ sattvaṁ tamaśh chaiva tamaḥ sattvaṁ rajas tathā

rajaḥ—mode of passion; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **cha**—and; **abhibhūya**—prevails; **sattvam**—mode of goodness; **bhavati**—becomes; **bhārata**—Arjun, the son of Bharat; **rajaḥ**—mode of passion; **sattvam**—mode of goodness; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **cha**—and; **eva**—indeed; **tamaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **sattvam**—mode of goodness; **rajaḥ**—mode of passion; **tathā**—also

Sattva asserts itself by prevailing over rajas and tamas, O Bhārata; rajas asserts itself by prevailing over sattva and tamas; and tamas asserts itself by prevailing over sattva and rajas.

166. Chapter 14 Verses 11-15

VERSE 14.11

सर्वद्वारेषु देहेऽस्मिन्प्रकाश उपजायते ।
ज्ञानं यदा तदा विद्याद्विवृद्धं सत्त्वमित्युत ॥ 11 ॥

sarva-dvāreṣhu dehe 'smin prakāśha upajāyate
jñānam yadā tadā vidyād vivṛiddham sattvam ity uta

sarva—all; dvāreṣhu—through the gates; dehe—body; asmin—in this; prakāśhaḥ—illumination; upajāyate—manifest; jñānam—knowledge; yadā—when; tadā—then; vidyāt—know; vivṛiddham—predominates; sattvam—mode of goodness; iti—thus; uta—certainly;

When the light of knowledge shines through all the gateways of the body, then it may be known that sattva has prevailed.

VERSE 14.12

लोभः प्रवृत्तिरारम्भः कर्मणामशमः स्पृहा ।
रजस्येतानि जायन्ते विवृद्धे भरतर्षभ ॥ 12 ॥

lobhaḥ pravṛittir ārambhaḥ karmaṇām aśhamāḥ spṛihā
rajasy etāni jāyante vivṛiddhe bharatarṣhabha

lobhaḥ—greed; **pravṛittiḥ**—activity; **ārambhaḥ**—exertion; **karmaṇām**—for
fruitive actions; **aśhamāḥ**—restlessness; **spṛihā**—craving; **rajasi**—of the mode
of passion; **etāni**—these; **jāyante**—develop; **vivṛiddhe**—when predominates;
bharata-ṛiṣhabha—the best of the Bharatas, Arjun;

**Greed, activity, enterprise, unrest, longing— these arise, O
lord of the Bhāratas, when rajas prevails.**

VERSE 14.13

aparakāśho 'pravṛittiśh cha pramādo moha eva cha
tamasy etāni jāyante vivṛiddhe kuru-nandana

aparakāśhaḥ—nescience; apravṛittiḥ—inertia; cha—and; pramādaḥ
—negligence; mohaḥ—delusion; eva—indeed; cha—also; tamasi—
mode of ignorance; etāni—these; jāyante—manifest; vivṛiddhe—
when dominates; kuru-nandana—the joy of the Kurus, Arjun

**Darkness, indolence, inadvertence, delusion— all these
arise, O descendant of Kuru, when tamas prevails.**

VERSE 14.14

यदा सत्त्वे प्रवृद्धे तु प्रलयं याति देहभृत् ।
तदोत्तमविदां लोकानमलान्प्रतिपद्यते ॥ 14 ॥

yadā sattve pravṛddhe tu pralayaṁ yāti deha-bhṛit
tadottama-vidāṁ lokān amalān pratipadyate

yadā—when; **sattve**—in the mode of goodness; **pravṛddhe**—when premodinates; **tu**—indeed; **pralayaṁ**—death; **yāti**—reach; **deha-bhṛit**—the embodied; **tadā**—then; **uttama-vidāṁ**—of the learned; **lokān**—abodes; **amalān**—pure; **pratipadyate**—attains;

**If the embodied soul meets with death when sattva prevails,
it goes to the spotless realms of those who know the Highest.**

VERSE 14.15

रजसि प्रलयं गत्वा कर्मसङ्गिषु जायते ।
तथा प्रलीनस्तमसि मूढयोनिषु जायते ॥ 15 ॥

rajasi pralayaṁ gatvā karma-saṅgiṣhu jāyate
tathā pralīnas tamasi mūḍha-yoniṣhu jāyate

rajasi—in the mode of passion; **pralayam**—death; **gatvā**—attaining; **karma-saṅgiṣhu**—among people driven by work; **jāyate**—are born; **tathā**—likewise; **pralīnaḥ**—dying; **tamasi**—in the mode of ignorance; **mūḍha-yoniṣhu**—in the animal kingdom; **jāyate**—takes birth

If the embodied soul meets with death when rajas prevails, it is born among those who are attached to action; and if it meets with death when tamas prevails, it is born in the wombs of creatures devoid of reason.

167. Chapter 14 Verses 16-20

VERSE 14.16

कर्मणः सुकृतस्याहुः सात्त्विकं निर्मलं फलम् ।
रजसस्तु फलं दुःखमज्ञानं तमसः फलम् ॥ 16 ॥

karmaṇaḥ sukṛitasyāhuḥ sāttvikam nirmalam phalam
rajasas tu phalam duḥkham ajñānam tamasaḥ phalam

karmaṇaḥ—of action; **su-kṛitasya**—pure; **āhuḥ**—is said; **sāttvikam**—mode of goodness; **nirmalam**—pure; **phalam**—result; **rajasas**—mode of passion; **tu**—indeed; **phalam**—result; **duḥkham**—pain; **ajñānam**—ignorance; **tamasaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **phalam**—result

The fruit of a good action is said to be good and clean; the fruit of rajas is pain; and the fruit of tamas is ignorance.

VERSE 14.17

सत्त्वात्सञ्जायते ज्ञानं रजसो लोभ एव च ।
प्रमादमोहौ तमसो भवतोऽज्ञानमेव च ॥ 17 ॥

sattvāt sañjāyate jñānam rajaso lobha eva cha
pramāda-mohau tamaso bhavato 'jñānam eva cha

sattvāt—from the mode of goodness; **sañjāyate**—arises; **jñānam**—knowledge; **rajasah**—from the mode of passion; **lobhah**—greed; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—and; **pramāda**—negligence; **mohau**—delusion; **tamasah**—from the mode of ignorance; **bhavatah**—arise; **ajñānam**—ignorance; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—and

**From sattva springs knowledge, and from rajas, greed; from
tamas spring inadvertence, delusion, and ignorance.**

VERSE 14.18

ऊर्ध्वं गच्छन्ति सत्त्वस्था मध्ये तिष्ठन्ति राजसाः ।
जघन्यगुणवृत्तिस्था अधो गच्छन्ति तामसाः ॥ 18 ॥

ūrdhvam gachchhanti sattva-sthā madhye tiṣṭhanti rājasāḥ
jaghanya-guṇa-vṛitti-sthā adho gachchhanti tāmasāḥ

ūrdhvam—upward; **gachchhanti**—rise; **sattva-sthāḥ**—those situated in the mode of goodness; **madhye**—in the middle; **tiṣṭhanti**—stay; **rājasāḥ**—those in the mode of passion; **jaghanya**—abominable; **guṇa**—quality; **vṛitti-sthāḥ**—engaged in activities; **adhaḥ**—down; **gachchhanti**—go; **tāmasāḥ**—those in the mode of ignorance

Those who are established in sattva go upward; those who are moved by rajas remain in the middle; and those who are steeped in tamas, being weighted by the tendencies of the lowest guna, go downward.

VERSE 14.19

नान्यं गुणेभ्यः कर्तारं यदा द्रष्टानुपश्यति ।
गुणेभ्यश्च परं वेत्ति मदभावं सोऽधिगच्छति ॥ 19 ॥

nānyam guṇebhyaḥ kartāraṁ yadā draṣṭānupaśhyati
guṇebhyaśh cha paraṁ vetti mad-bhāvaṁ so 'dhigachchhati

na—no; anyam—other; guṇebhyaḥ—of the guṇas; kartāraṁ—agents of action; yadā—when; draṣṭā—the seer; anupaśhyati—see; guṇebhyaḥ—to the modes of nature; cha—and; paraṁ—transcendental; vetti—know; mad-bhāvaṁ—my divine nature; saḥ—they; adhigachchhati—attain

**When a man of insight beholds no agent other than the
gunas, and also knows Him who is beyond the gunas, he
attains My being.**

VERSE 14.20

गुणानेतानतीत्य त्रीन्देही देहसमुद्भवान् ।
जन्ममृत्युजरादुःखैर्विमुक्तोऽमृतमश्नुते ॥ 20 ॥

guṇān etān atītya trīn dehī deha-samudbhavān
janma-mṛityu-jarā-duḥkhair vimukto 'mṛitam aśhnute

guṇān—the three modes of material nature; **etān**—these; **atītya**—transcending;
trīn—three; **dehī**—the embodied; **deha**—body; **samudbhavān**—produced of;
janma—birth; **mṛityu**—death; **jarā**—old age; **duḥkhaiḥ**—misery; **vimuktaḥ**—
free from; **amṛitam**—immortality; **aśhnute**—attains

When the embodied soul has risen above the three gunas of which its body is made, it gains deliverance from birth, death, old age, and pain and becomes immortal.

168. Chapter 14 Verses 21-22

VERSE 14.21

अर्जुन उवाच ।
कैर्लिङ्गैस्त्रीन्गुणानेतानतीतो भवति प्रभो ।
किमाचारः कथं चैतांस्त्रीन्गुणानतिवर्तते ॥ 21 ॥

arjuna uvācha

kair liṅgais trīn guṇān etān atīto bhavati prabho

kim āchāraḥ katham chaitāns trīn guṇān ativartate

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun inquired; **kaiḥ**—by what; **liṅgaiḥ**—symptoms; **trīn**—three; **guṇān**—modes of material nature; **etān**—these; **atītaḥ**—having transcended; **bhavati**—is; **prabho**—Lord; **kim**—what; **āchāraḥ**—conduct; **katham**—how; **cha**—and; **etān**—these; **trīn**—three; **guṇān**—modes of material nature; **ativartate**—transcend

Arjuna said: What are the marks, O Lord, of the man who has risen above the three gunas? What is his conduct? And how does he rise above the gunas?

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

प्रकाशं च प्रवृत्तिं च मोहमेव च पाण्डव ।

न द्वेष्टि सम्प्रवृत्तानि न निवृत्तानि काङ्क्षति ॥ 22 ॥

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha

prakāśham cha pravṛittim cha moham eva cha pāṇḍava

na dveṣṭi sampravṛittāni na nivṛittāni kāṅkṣhati

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Divine Personality said; **prakāśham**—illumination; **cha**—and; **pravṛittim**—activity; **cha**—and; **moham**—delusion; **eva**—even; **cha**—and; **pāṇḍava**—Arjun, the son of Pandu; **na dveṣṭi**—do not hate; **sampravṛittāni**—when present; **na**—nor; **nivṛittāni**—when absent; **kāṅkṣhati**—longs;

**He sits like one unconcerned, unaffected by the Gunas,
knowing that the Gunas are functioning, and is not moved.**

169. Chapter 14 Verses 23-25

VERSE 14.23-25

उदासीनवदासीनो गुणैर्यो न विचाल्यते ।
गुणा वर्तन्त इत्येवं योऽवतिष्ठति नेङ्गते ॥ 23 ॥
समदुःखसुखः स्वस्थः समलोष्टाश्मकाञ्चनः ।
तुल्यपिरयापिरयो धीरस्तुल्यनिन्दात्मसंस्तुतिः ॥ 24 ॥
मानापमानयोस्तुल्यस्तुल्यो मित्रारिपक्षयोः ।
सर्वारम्भपरित्यागी गुणातीतः स उच्यते ॥ 25 ॥

udāsīna-vad āsīno guṇair yo na vichālyate
guṇā vartanta ity evaṁ yo 'vatiṣṭhati neṅgate
sama-duḥkha-sukhaḥ sva-sthaḥ sama-loṣṭāśhma-kāñchanah
tulya-priyāpriyo dhīras tulya-nindātma-sanstutiḥ
mānāpamānayos tulyas tulyo mitrāri-pakṣhayoḥ
sarvārambha-parityāgī guṇātītaḥ sa uchyate

udāsīna-vat—neutral; **āsīnah**—situated; **guṇaiḥ**—to the modes of material nature; **yaḥ**—who; **na**—not; **vichālyate**—are disturbed; **guṇāḥ**—modes of material nature; **vartante**—act; **iti-evam**—knowing it in this way; **yaḥ**—who; **avatiṣṭhati**—established in the self; **na**—not; **iṅgate**—wavering; **sama**—alike; **duḥkha**—distress; **sukhaḥ**—happiness; **sva-sthaḥ**—established in the self; **sama**—equally; **loṣṭa**—a clod; **aśhma**—stone; **kāñchanah**—gold; **tulya**—of equal value; **priya**—pleasant; **apriyaḥ**—unpleasant; **dhīraḥ**—steady; **tulya**—the same; **nindā**—blame; **ātma-sanstutiḥ**—praise; **māna**—honor; **apamānayoh**—dishonor; **tulyaḥ**—equal; **tulyaḥ**—equal; **mitra**—friend; **ari**—foe; **pakṣhayoh**—to the parties; **sarva**—all; **ārambha**—enterprises; **parityāgī**—renouncer; **guṇa-atītaḥ**—risen above the three modes of material nature; **saḥ**—they; **uchyate**—are said to have

He sits like one unconcerned, unaffected by the Gunas, knowing that the Gunas are functioning, and is not moved. He is equal-minded in joy and sorrow, established in Self; regards a clod, a stone, and gold alike; the same in pleasant and unpleasant things; heroic, equal in censure and praise. He is the same in honour and dishonour; the same towards friends and enemies; abandons all actions; he is said to be Gunatita.

170. Chapter 14 Verses 26-27

VERSE 14.26

मां च योऽव्यभिचारेण भक्तियोगेन सेवते ।
स गुणान्समतीत्यैतान्ब्रह्मभूयाय कल्पते ॥ 26 ॥

mām cha yo 'vyabhichāreṇa bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guṇān samatītyaitān brahma-bhūyāya kalpate

mām—me; **cha**—only; **yaḥ**—who; **avyabhichāreṇa**—unalloyed; **bhakti-yogena**—through devotion; **sevate**—serve; **saḥ**—they; **guṇān**—the three modes of material nature; **samatītya**—rise above; **etān**—these; **brahma-bhūyāya**—level of Brahman; **kalpate**—comes to

**And he who worships Me with the yoga of undeviating love
rises above the gunas and becomes fit to be one with
Brahman.**

ब्रह्मणो हि प्रतिष्ठाहममृतस्याव्ययस्य च ।
शाश्वतस्य च धर्मस्य सुखस्यैकान्तिकस्य च ॥ 27 ॥

brahmaṇo hi pratiṣṭhāham amṛitasyāvyayasya cha
śhāśhvatasya cha dharmasya sukhasyaikāntikasya cha

brahmaṇaḥ—of Brahman; **hi**—only; **pratiṣṭhā**—the basis; **aham**—I; **amṛitasya**—of the immortal; **avyayasya**—of the imperishable; **cha**—and; **śhāśhvatasya**—of the eternal; **cha**—and; **dharmasya**—of the dharma; **sukhasya**—of bliss; **aikāntikasya**—unending; **cha**—and

**For I am the Abode of Brahman, the Immortal and the
Immutable, and of the Eternal Dharma, and of Absolute
Bliss.**